



Audi's e-tron car

Audi could rename its all-electric car as 'e-tron', an SUV based on the e-tron Quattro concept. <http://dgit.in/Adietron>



Amazon's Family Vault

Amazon Prime now allows you to extend the photo storage benefit with s family. <http://dgit.in/FmlyVlt>

alphabet keys. A 15-inch keyboard will ensure even Shift, Control, Enter, and Arrow key sizes aren't compromised upon, so writers should choose a 15-inch laptop for best typing comfort. Also, backlit keyboards are great for typing in the dark. But a 15-inch laptop is also not as ultraportable as a 10-inch or 12-inch thin and light notebook that you can take down to the coffee shop or park bench whenever you're looking for inspiration to strike.

Another thing to consider – Do you want a glossy screen or a matte screen laptop? Matte screens are great for reading text only, glossy is great for

more Chromebooks are cheaper than Windows laptops. Something to consider for sure.

What does it take to choose the most optimal configuration on a tight budget?

Intel Core i3 vs Core i5? Intel HD vs Dedicated Graphics? DDR3 vs DDR4 RAM? Full HD vs 720p screen? What matters?

While shopping for a laptop on a tight budget, it's important to know what matters and what doesn't. First and foremost, a gospel truth needs to be understood: You can't have it all in a budget laptop. When you're shopping for a laptop around the Rs 30k-35k mark, be prepared for compromises.

Build quality: You can't expect a budget laptop to be built ruggedly. While they don't self-destruct at the slightest bump or disintegrate on their own, corners are cut and instead of metal parts, brushed



Keep all the factors in mind before you dive into a purchase

jazzing up everything else to the max. In both cases, having an anti-reflective coating helps reduce eye strain, but a matte screen is still highly recommended for a writer over a glossy screen found in laptop these days. Hint: Matte screens are rare on consumer notebooks, but still available on business notebooks, if you look hard.

A Chromebook is a good out-of-the-box alternative for a writer, especially because of its deep integration with Google Drive. All your work-in-progress projects, documents, etc., are easily saved and synced online. Unlike Windows, Chrome OS is distraction-free and forces you to concentrate on only limited things – pretty much life lived inside a Chrome browser window. This is great for you to focus on your script and type with aplomb. What's

aluminium surfaces and steel alloy chassis found in premium notebooks, budget laptops make do with plastic shells and surfaces to reduce cost. Luckily, it's an industry wide trend, so the penny-pinching is done by every laptop manufacturer.

Form factor: Should a budget laptop be small and cheap or large and more expensive? By that we mean, should it be a 10-inch low-powered, sub-20k netbook or should it be a 15-inch laptop with a proper mainstream configuration selling for 30-35k? Well, this totally depends on your budget, and form factors play a big role in deciding the final price of the laptop. As a general thumb rule, in the budget segment, the smaller the laptop the lower its cost, and the larger the laptop the higher its cost.

Tradeoffs to consider here are smaller laptops are difficult to use, lower performing but offer best battery life; while larger laptops are more ergonomic, better performing but offer lower battery life.

Slower newer vs faster older: This is a very important tradeoff to consider while choosing a budget laptop online. Newer generation, latest Intel Core i3/i5/i7 processor based laptops are debuting in the market, so are laptops with DDR4 RAM (which is the newer generation after DDR3 RAM). Obviously these newer hardware platforms will sell for higher in the marketplace. Therefore, you should try to eye a deal in the budget segment that's offering a previous-generation laptop at a throwaway price.

For example, if the latest Intel Core i3, 2GB DDR4 RAM-powered 14-inch laptop is selling at 35k, it's possible to find an older-generation Intel Core i5, 4GB DDR3 RAM-powered 14 or 15-inch laptop selling at the same price online. Why? Because as the markets start flooding with newer generation laptops, sellers would want to get rid of their older inventory quickly – most of the times at attractive discount. So keep an eye out for these bargains.

OS vs no OS: Another way to cut cost on a budget notebook is to buy one which sells with only Linux or DOS operating system. No Windows. Why? Because that further reduces the price of the laptop by an additional Rs 4k. So if you find a laptop that's selling for 40k, chances are an identical SKU of the same machine with the same internal hardware exists and sells for 35-36k without Windows OS built-in.

Tradeoff tweaks: In our quest to maximize our value proposition and try to get the best possible hardware in our laptop, here are things to remember. Getting more RAM over a faster processor is a smart choice. A hybrid drive over just a pure HDD can and will add to the performance numbers. There's no need for a Full HD screen, 1366x768 pixel resolution is fine. No need AMD or NVIDIA graphics, Intel HD is just fine.